Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/33

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

Source B: From a confidential memo by a leading NAACP attorney to the executive board, 1953.
Our courtroom strategy is yielding significant results. By initiating litigation in the federal courts, we have successfully outlawed the exclusionary white primary system in Texas and are now targeting segregation in higher education. The federal courts are our primary arena, and by leveraging constitutional guarantees, we are compelling the government to recognize that segregation is inherently discriminatory.

Source C

Source C: A description by a CORE volunteer in an organizational bulletin, 1952, detailing a protest in a northern community.
Our group conducted a quiet, orderly demonstration at a local department store restaurant, requesting basic service. The staff ignored us, and a hostile crowd assembled shortly after. We endured insults, physical assault, and were forcibly ejected while local law enforcement officers watched with amusement. This demonstration proves that federal policy adjustments do not automatically dissolve local hostility.

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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

Interpretation 1: From a modern historical study.
During the early 1950s, civil rights groups achieved critical legal milestones. The NAACP focused on a systematic litigation campaign in federal courts, bypassing obstructionist Southern officials. These courtroom triumphs demonstrated that the legal pillars of Jim Crow were vulnerable, establishing a crucial legal precedent that enabled the broader grassroots campaigns of the next decade.

Interpretation 2

Interpretation 2: From a different historical perspective.
Regardless of the legal successes in the early 1950s, day-to-day conditions for Southern Black Americans remained virtually unaltered. Supreme Court rulings lacked enforcement, allowing local segregationist leaders to ignore them. Power on the ground was maintained by hostile white groups and local police who used violence and economic reprisal to suppress any challenges to segregation.

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